AI Bootcamp — Week 4: Coaching Readiness & Certification Gate

Thursday — Student Exercise Guide

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OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 4, the candidate is cleared for Deep Learning Program (DLP) engagement — meaning they can:

- Deliver the player-coach model in a live pairing session with a Basic Prompting-level developer
- Recognize the difference between real adoption and polite compliance
- Handle the four most common resistance patterns (skeptic, over-truster, identity-protective senior, management blocker)
- Explain EDD, RTCC (WHO/WHAT/WHY/HOW), the load-bearing rule, and the Prompt/Harness/Model framework clearly to a developer who has never heard of any of them
- Produce artifacts that a client can use after the Embedded Engineer is gone
- Articulate the full DLP arc: two 6-week loops, 6 Trainer sessions landing at weeks 1/3/5/7/9/11, the introduce-then-reinforce cadence, the transfer model (workspace to real codebase), and the Stage 3 to Stage 4 trajectory
- Operate their half of the two-person delivery model: Trainer touchpoints, escalation rules, and the Week 12 joint rubric
- Pass the Certification Gate

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TIMING

- **Monday–Friday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each day)

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THURSDAY (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM): REHEARSAL ENGAGEMENT

9:00 AM – 10:30 AM — SIMULATED PAIRING SESSION

Run a simulated 90-minute "Week 1 Day 1" pairing session with a colleague playing a Basic Prompting-level developer.

The colleague should:

- Use Basic Prompting behaviors (off-the-shelf prompts, no structure, no evaluation, full trust in AI output)
- Ask realistic questions ("why do we need test cases if the AI output looks good?")
- Resist where a real developer would resist, but not be hostile
- Refer to the AI Adoption Maturity Assessment for calibration

The Embedded Engineer candidate facilitates without a script. Their goal in this session is not to teach the whole program — it is to get the developer to do one EDD cycle on one real task from their actual work.

10:30 – 11:30 AM — DEBRIEF

Structured debrief with the colleague and instructor:

- What worked? Where did the developer engage?
- Where did the candidate default to telling rather than coaching?
- Where did the candidate lose the developer?
- Did the candidate get to EDD, or did they spend the whole session on RTCC setup?
- If the developer left this session and came back tomorrow, what would they do differently?

11:30 AM – 12:00 PM — ADJUSTMENTS

Based on the debrief: what would you do differently in the first 15 minutes? Revise your approach and briefly demonstrate the adjusted opening.

12:00 – 1:00 PM — LUNCH

1:00 – 3:00 PM — BEHAVIOR CHANGE OBSERVATION

Program manager observes the candidate doing a normal work task — ideally something genuinely from their current real work, not a constructed exercise. The candidate works naturally, without narrating.

The observer notes: which artifacts are used? Which are not? Does the candidate run manual test cases before building, or after? Does the candidate perform the load-bearing audit, or is that only something they do when reminded?

Debrief afterward: what the observer saw, not what the candidate thought they did.

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3:00 – 5:00 PM — FINAL ARTIFACT REVIEW AND SUBMISSION PREPARATION

Review the full certification gate checklist. Identify any outstanding items. For any item that is incomplete, commit to a specific completion time before the end of Day 5.

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